



Elemental composition of the human body

Shown above are the most common elements of the human body, and the exact types of stars that they originated from. Some parts of you, including the hydrogen may be as old as the universe itself. There are trace amounts of beryllium and boron in the human body, created by cosmic ray spallation. There are also elements that are heavier than rubidium in the human body, and while their biological roles may not be fully understood, they were created by colliding or exploding neutron stars.

“The cosmos is within us. We are made of star-stuff. We are a way for the universe to know itself.”
—Carl Sagan, *Cosmos*

“In order that we might live, stars in their billions, tens of billions, hundreds of billions even, have died. The iron in our blood, the calcium in our bones, the oxygen that fills our lungs each time we take a breath - all were cooked in the furnaces of stars which expired long before the earth was born.”
—Marcus Chown, *The Magic Furnace*

“The amazing thing is that every atom in your body came from a star that exploded. And, the atoms in your left hand probably came from a different star than your right hand. It really is the most poetic thing I know about physics: You are all stardust. You couldn't be here if stars hadn't exploded, because the elements - the carbon, nitrogen, oxygen, iron, all the things that matter for evolution - weren't created at the beginning of time. They were created in the nuclear furnaces of stars, and the only way they could get into your body is if those stars were kind enough to explode.”
—Lawrence M Krauss, *A Universe from Nothing*